

HTML5 and JavaScript Game Development Engines

>>While most people today are looking for a quick turnaround time for game development in the same breath as going multiplatform, the quickest option for developers is to consider HTML5> by Mariam Dholkawala

HTML5 started off being a highly anticipated platform a couple of years back. It was meant to take over Adobe Flash, and even today continues to gain popularity and curiosity amongst developers. A lot of talk of HTML5 might have begun with Apple not supporting Flash on iOS devices, but HTML5 largely got known for its cross platform feature, thus evolving as a preferred platform.

What makes game development simpler with HTML5 are the frameworks and tools currently available. We've compiled a list that of some of these tools.

Construct 2



Construct 2 is an HTML5 game engine that allows anyone to make games across platforms without any programming experience. It enables rapid game development with ready physics behavior to add to game objects.

Working with Construct2 is as simple as dragging your game objects (images) to a canvas screen and setting properties and

behavior to them. The downside of this is that the engine may limit creativity if you want to add a behavior that is not compatible with the engine.

The Construct2 engine comes in 3 editions; one of them being completely free for an unlimited time. However to use it for a commercial project a license needs to be purchased.

They have some great demos to show how powerful the engine is for game development on their website.

Cost: Free for non commercial projects

Platforms: Web Browsers, iOS, Android, Windows 8 Metro App, Chrome Web Store

Website: <http://www.scirra.com/construct2>

LimeJS



LimeJS is a JavaScript game framework for web browsers and mobile platforms (iOS and Android). Released under the

Apache license, the framework ensures that games can be created in the shortest time supporting every modern browser that

runs HTML5. Digital Fruit developed LimeJS as part-time project when there was a lack of tools for developing HTML5 based games especially for touch screens (iOS, Android). LimeJS's goal is quite clear: to provide an easy way to build good game experiences without thinking about details that go into writing complex game code.

The framework is free and open source. They have some nice demos for inspiration and programming guide to begin game development.

Cost: Free Open Source

Platforms: Web Browsers, iOS, Android

Website: <http://www.limejs.com/>, <http://www.digitalfruit.eu/>

Impact JS



Impact is a JavaScript Game Engine that allows development of HTML5 Games for desktop and mobile browsers (iPad, iPhone and iPod Touch). The engine

makes great use of the canvas element and comes with a 2D level editor for side scrolling games or top down RPG games.

The website has a list of tools and libraries that can be integrated with ImpactJS. The engine is not free though.

What makes ImpactJS unique from the other engines is that it comes with a 2D Weltmeister Level Editor that helps create side scrolling and top-down RPG games easily. It also has debug tools which helps identify performance bottlenecks. It is also based upon an Ejecta Framework that renders the game via OpenGL on iOS improving performance.

Cost: \$99 per license for unlimited game development

Platforms: Web Browsers, iOS

Website: <http://impactjs.com/>

Game Salad



This HTML5 game engine makes game creation easy because it has a drag and drop interface and a complex behavior library for game designers. The engine comes with an In-App Previewer that emulates the game display on a mobile screen. The engine can go cross platform including iOS,